

Some argue that website design should be considered as an art form in its own right. While most of us have far more modest ambitions, it's still worth noting that the intricacies of website development and the attention to detail it demands could well be at par with what an artist invests on his work, if not more so.

The fact that designing and launching a website has become very easy in the 21st century shouldn't lull you into thinking that it's all a breeze. Not if you want to create a website that will truly cater to the needs of your audience.

Design and interactivity play crucial roles in the success of a site. You will be surprised by how much these things depend not a highly evolved visual aesthetic (though that undoubtedly helps) but largely on careful consideration of different elements.

Let's take a look a look at them right here:

1. Use icons only where appropriate

You've heard the saying, "Too many cooks spoil the broth." Now, here's something you haven't heard before: "Too many icons ruin the site." But just because it's gone largely unarticulated in popular culture doesn't mean that it's not true. On the contrary, stuffing a webpage with icons can make browsing a clutter-filled prospect, one that could confuse the audience more than guide them.

The ideal then lies in reductionism- eliminating as many icons as possible, leaving just the necessary ones. Sometimes, the icons could replace text-bursts entirely, bringing more space to the page. A couple of things to keep in mind about icons are mentioned here:

- You can deliver the icons in the SVG (Scalable Vector Graphics) format. The format is great for creating websites that will be viewed on multiple devices-the icons can be resized according to your requirements, and that too without 'fattening' the file size.
- Trying simple animated icons could also be a great idea (provided you don't go overboard with it). You can animate SVG files using CSS. This way, you needn't wallow in a lot of extra scripts to bring in some decent effects.



This icon can mean "click" or it can have something to do with changing your input. Which is it?